Straichemy
Strategies that Strike Gold

Case Study · Professional Services · Practice Growth Strategy

Exceptional at the work.

Finally, exceptional at the business.

How a specialist consulting firm stopped trading time for money, built a practice that scaled beyond its founders, and positioned itself as the go-to name in its niche - with **Stralchemy**.

Revenue per Partner	Retainer Revenue Share	Inbound Pipeline
+83%	**9% → 54%**	**4.2x**
through productization & pricing	project dependency broken	from thought leadership strategy

BACKGROUND

A specialist consulting firm operating in the governance, risk, and compliance space had built a reputation over a decade that its principals were quietly proud of — repeat mandates from blue-chip clients, strong referrals from peer firms, and work that genuinely moved the needle for the organisations it served. But the business behind the practice was fundamentally fragile. Revenue was entirely project-based, pipelines were invisible between mandates, and the firm's growth was capped by the billable hours its four partners could personally deliver. Every new engagement required a partner in the room. Every holiday was a revenue gap.

Stralchemy was engaged to help the firm think — and operate — like a business, not a collection of expert individuals.

PAINPOINTS

Four structural limitations had kept a highly capable firm from growing beyond its founders for over decade:

Billing hours, not building value

Every rupee of revenue was tied to a partner's time. The firm had no productized services, no leveraged delivery model, and no way to grow revenue without growing partner hours - a ceiling that had been reached years ago.

Project revenue with no predictability

91% of revenue came from project mandates with no forward visibility. The firm swung between feast and famine with no buffer - partners were simultaneously chasing new work and delivering existing mandates, with no dedicated business development function.

Expertise invisible outside referrals

The firm's knowledge and track record were genuinely market-leading - but entirely invisible beyond its existing client network. No thought leadership, no published perspective, no digital presence. New clients arrived only when a known contact made an introduction.

Talent not trusted to deliver

A capable team of eight senior associates handled execution - but client relationships and final deliverables always went through a partner. There was no structured pathway to delegate client ownership, and the associates had no incentive to grow into it.

THE STRALCHEMY ENGAGEMENT

Stralchemy ran a 12-week practice transformation engagement — covering service design, revenue model restructure, talent leverage, and market positioning. The engagement was deliberately structured to respect the firm's hard-won reputation while dismantling the operational patterns that were capping its future.

1. Service Productization

Stralchemy worked with the partners to codify the firm's three highest-demand service areas into structured, repeatable products — each with a defined scope, a fixed deliverable set, and a transparent price. Bespoke engagements were retained for complex mandates; productised offerings handled the volume. Delivery of productised services was delegated to senior associates, freeing partner time for client relationships and business development.

2. Retainer Model Introduction

A structured retainer proposition was designed for existing clients — ongoing advisory access, quarterly reviews, and priority response windows in exchange for a fixed monthly fee. **Stralchemy** built the commercial case and the the pitch framework; the partners ran the conversations. Within six months, 54% of revenue was retainer-based — transforming the firm's cash flow visibility from near-zero to six months forward.

3. Thought Leadership as Pipeline

Stralchemy designed a content and positioning strategy built entirely around the partners' existing expertise — a quarterly insight publication, a LinkedIn presence with a structured publishing cadence, and a speaking programme targeting the industry events their ideal clients attended. Within 90 days of launch, inbound enquiries began arriving from organisations the firm had never been referred to. The pipeline multiplied 4.2× within a year.

4. Talent Leverage Framework

A structured client ownership pathway was built for senior associates — a competency framework, a client introduction protocol, and a revenue-linked incentive structure that gave associates both the clarity and the motivation to grow into client-facing roles. Partners were freed from being the sole point of contact on every engagement. The firm's delivery capacity effectively doubled without a single new hire.

OUTCOMES

Revenue decoupled from partner hours

Revenue per partner grew 83% - driven by productized services delivered by associates and retainer income that required no active selling once signed. Partners worked the same hours and earned significantly more.

Predictable revenue at last

Retainer revenue grew from 9% to 54% of total within six months. The firm entered every quarter with a known revenue floor - and a business development pipeline to build on top of it.

Inbound pipeline from expertise

Thought leadership content generated 4.2x the previous inbound enquiry volume within 12 months. Three of the year's five largest mandates came from organizations that had found the firm through published content - not a referral.

A firm, not just four partners

Six of eight senior associates moved into structured client ownership roles within the first year. For the first time, the firm could grow its client base without adding partners - and its valuation reflected a business, not a group of freelancers with a shared address.

"We had spent ten years building expertise. What we hadn't built was a firm.
Stralchemy showed us the difference - and the gap was larger than we expected, and faster to close than we feared."

Managing Partner, Specialist Consulting Firm
(Identity withheld at client request)

Your Growth, Our Blueprint – Start Now!

→ **stralchemy.com**